Claudio Palana

EXPERIENCE ARCHITECT, FULL-STACK PRODUCT LEAD

💼Claudiopalana.work
📞(+49) 1756027958
📧claudio.palana@gmail.com
📍Hamburg, Germany

*A dynamic **Product Lead** with extensive experience leading the development of interactive products. My particular value proposition stems from the smooth integration of **UX/UI Design** talents, a strong technical **programming basis**, and a strategic **Product Management** approach. I am an expert in gamification and **audio software**, with practical experience in **AI**, **LLMs**, and computer vision.*

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance Self-Employed — *Web Designer / UX Designer / Graphic Designer*

JANUARY 2015 - CURRENT

- Created end-to-end visual identities and scalable brand guidelines for rising firms and esports organisations from "day zero."
- Led the UX/UI redesign and development of the **University of Liverpool's International Veterinary Hub**, emphasising accessibility and information hierarchy.
- Created eye-catching posters and promotional materials for worldwide concerts, utilising strategic typography to increase audience interaction.
- Created unique illustrations and items for gaming communities to increase brand loyalty and identification.

Synergeticon GmbH — *UX/UI Designer & Product Manager*

MAY 2023 - JUNE 2025

- As a hybrid professional, I led the design and product strategy for an **AI** and Computer Vision-based **SaaS** platform, serving as the key liaison between external project requirements and the development team.
- **Drove the product strategy** and **development roadmap** for an AI platform, managing over 20 new features and their release timelines.
- **Facilitated cross-functional collaboration**, acting as a bridge between developers and project managers. I managed work between **frontend** and **backend** teams, ensuring **strategic alignment** and a fluid development process.
- Designed and **maintained a scalable Design System**, optimizing the development team's workflow and enhancing the overall user experience of the offered solutions.
- **Collaborated** closely **with developers on code reviews** (VueJS, Python, Go, Rest API, and GraphQL), providing feedback and ensuring optimal implementation of design solutions. I also **oversaw industrialization** and **versioning** practices in Docker and GitHub.
- Led the development of **AI-driven solutions** in sectors such as logistics, aerospace, automotive, manufacturing, and green energy.
- Worked on projects with partners including **Volkswagen, AIRBUS, Lufthansa Technik, BMW,** and **HVV**, and contributed to various German government projects: **Aerospace-X**, **DIAMOND**, **Smartromain**, **SMILE**, **IPrefer**, **Digipro2Green**, and **Zirkel**.

Versy FZCO — *Design & Product Experience Manager*

NOVEMBER 2022 - MAY 2023

- I guided the **design strategy** and **brand identity** for a startup, curating the end-to-end user experience and contributing to business growth in a key leadership role.
- Defined the **brand identity and awareness**, managing design for the web presence, social media, and marketing content to attract new investors.
- Acted as the lead for user experience, designing interactive interfaces and flows for a **no-code editor** platform in the metaverse, utilizing a **Unity** and **WebGL** environment for eCommerce.
- Managed the **quality assurance (QA) testing** of new features, conducting tests to ensure product integrity and a seamless user experience.

Singe Holdings, LLC — *Digital Marketing Intern*

JULY 2022 - JANUARY 2023

- I created and optimized digital assets and marketing campaigns. **Conducted market research** and **competitor analysis** to identify new opportunities for growth and optimization.
- Developed and **scheduled social media content** and multi-channel marketing campaigns.
- Assisted in **UX/UI improvements** to optimize the user experience on digital assets.
- Supported **Conversion Optimization** initiatives and **A/B testing** for Growth in Social Medias.

EDUCATION

Master's Degree in Piano Jazz, Messina — *"A. Corelli" Conservatory*

OCTOBER 2019 - JULY 2022

GPA Max | 110/110 Summa cum Laude and Honours

CERTIFICATIONS

Fastweb Digital Academy
SEPTEMBER - OCTOBER 2022

UX/UI Design, UX/UI Gamification, UX & Psychology, Design System

ESB Level 2 Certificate in ESOL International All Modes (C1 CEFR)
MAY - NOVEMBER 2022

LinkedIn eLearning
JULY - AUGUST 2022

User Experience:
Become a User Experience Designer;
Empathy in UX Design;
Layout and Composition - Advanced;
User Experience for Web Design.

Tools & Software:
Adobe Illustrator for Web Design;
Figma for UX Design; Miro for UX.
Google Sheets Essential Training;

Audio & Sound Design:
Audio Design for Interactive Projects;
Audio Mastering Techniques;
Produce Audio for Interactive Projects;
Sound Design for Motion Graphics.

Product Management:
Build Your Critical Thinking Skills;
Better Judgment and Decision-Making;
Systems Thinking for Product Designers;
Developing Your Creativity as a Leader;
Agile Methodologies.

Unity Certified Associate Game Developer:
UI and 2D Games; Audio and Effects.

SOFTWARE & TOOLS

Productivity & Collaboration:

- Google Suite - *Expert*
- Jira - *Expert*
- Confluence - *Expert*
- Miro - *Expert*

Design & Prototyping:

- Microsoft Office - *Expert*
- Adobe Creative Suite - *Expert*
- Sketch - *Proficient*
- Figma - *Expert*
- Webflow - *Expert*

Audio & AI:

- Reaper - *Expert*
- ComfyUI (Generative AI) - *Expert*
- LLM Prompt Engineering - *Expert*
- AI Training, Dataset Creation - *Proficient*

TECHNICAL ACUMEN

My technical expertise is centred on a deep understanding of systems, enabling effective collaboration. I am skilled in code review and working closely with development teams to identify issues and ensure the optimal implementation of design solutions.

Languages & Technologies:

- **HTML** - *Proficient*
- ***CSS*** - *Proficient*
- **SCSS** - *Basic Knowledge*
- **Tailwind** - *Basic Knowledge*
- **VueJS** - *Competent*
- **React** - *Competent*
- **JavaScript** - *Basic Knowledge*
- **TypeScript** - *Basic Knowledge*
- **Python** - *Competent*
- **C#** - *Competent*
- **C++** - *Novice*
- **Neo4J** - *Novice*
- **SQL** - *Competent*
- **Node.JS** - *Basic Knowledge*
- **Golang** - *Novice*

LANGUAGES

Italian C2 - *Native Speaker*
English C1 - *Fluent/Full Proficiency - Oxford Certificate*
German A2 - *Good reading &listening understanding*
Spanish A2 - *Good reading &listening understanding*

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product Strategy & Vision

- Roadmap Development
- Market Analysis
- Competitor Analysis
- Objective Definition

Backlog & Prioritization Management

- Task Creation and Management
- Requirements and User Stories
- Prioritization Methods (RICE, Kano)
- Sprint and Release Planning

Agile methodologies & team leadership

- Agile, Scrum, Kanban
- Management and moderation of organizational meetings (Daily Scrum, Review, Retros)
- Cross-functional collaboration and communication

User Research & Analysis (UX)

- Conducting Qualitative Research
- Conducting Quantitative Research
- Creating Personas and Customer Journey Maps

Architecture & Information Design

- User Flow Development
- Wireframe Creation
- Interactive Prototype Design
- Visual Design and Interaction

User Interface Creation (UI)

- Design and Usability Principles
- Design System Creation and Management
- Interaction Design
- Typography and Colour Theory

Testing & Validation

- Conducting Usability Tests
- Analysis and Interpretation of User Feedback
- A/B Testing

Conversion Rate Optimization (CRO)

- Analytical & Data Skills
- Research & Auditing
- Copywriting & Content Strategy